

INTRODUCTION

How many books have you bought on money, business and finance? One, four, ten, twenty? Or maybe you've lost count?

Now, be honest. How many of those books did you read cover to cover? More importantly, how many of those books caused you to make radical, lasting money changes?

That's what I thought.

The truth is many of us are enamoured by the idea of sorting ourselves out financially. In the same way we might get excited about becoming fit, running a marathon, finding a partner, losing 5 kilos or giving up sugar.

Starting the process can seem easy and even a little exciting. Maybe you signed up to gym classes, hired a personal trainer, made an appointment with a financial planner or accountant, signed up to RSVP or set up online bank accounts to start seriously saving. But it's the second week of 6 a.m. sessions with your personal trainer when you're not on holidays where it starts becoming difficult. Or dealing with sugar cravings at 4 p.m. every day, trying desperately to resist the call of a Tim Tam. Or finding yourself on three dud dates in a row, wondering what the point of that RSVP subscription was. Or saying no to a day of shopping with girlfriends because you know your willpower won't hold out and now you're sitting at home, miserable, wishing you were there.

That's when sorting yourself out starts to kind of suck. So, you stop.

Not permanently, mind you. Just for a little while. After all, it's been a hard week and you want to give yourself a break. Or it's the silly season/summer/birthday month and starting any kind of diet or budget is just madness right now. A week turns into a month, which turns into a